

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 875

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Michael Aaron Butler on thirty years of service to the Tennessee Wildlife Federation.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Michael Aaron Butler of Jackson, who is celebrating thirty years of service to the Tennessee Wildlife Federation this year; and

WHEREAS, a lifelong outdoorsman who grew up hunting and fishing in West Tennessee, Michael Butler studied wildlife biology at the University of Tennessee and received his master's degree in wildlife biology from Montana State University; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Butler began his career at the Tennessee Conservation League in 1996 as a Technical Advisor and was promoted to Director of Conservation Programs in 1998; and

WHEREAS, Michael Butler became Chief Executive Officer of the newly renamed Tennessee Wildlife Federation in 2002; since that time, he has worked diligently and with uncommon resolve to grow the organization in depth and impact; and

WHEREAS, during his time at the Federation, the organization has grown to become a model for policy and program success for state conservation organizations; and

WHEREAS, he has been appointed to numerous boards and advisory groups throughout his tenure, including an appointment by President George W. Bush to serve on the Board of Trustees for the Morris K. and Stewart L. Udall Foundation for Scholarship and Excellence in Environmental Policy; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Butler is currently proud to chair the advisory board of the School of Natural Resources at his alma mater, the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, under his leadership, the Federation has grown to include programs such as the Scholastic Clay Target Program, Hunters for the Hungry, and the Hunting and Fishing Academy – which have served to introduce tens of thousands of Tennesseans to the outdoors and the shooting sports; and

WHEREAS, these programs have received national recognition for their success in the recruitment, retention and reactivation movement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Butler has led the conservation of thousands of acres of wetland, grassland, and forest habitats through the Federation's programs; he played a key role in the reintroduction of elk into Tennessee by working with landowners, sportsmen, and State and local government officials; and

WHEREAS, he has also worked alongside numerous lawmakers and staff throughout his career to conserve Tennessee's outdoors and sporting heritage, including spearheading the efforts to pass Tennessee's Constitutional Right to Hunt and Fish, securing this right for sportsmen for generations to come; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Butler epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly acknowledge and applaud Mr. Butler for his dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Michael Aaron Butler for thirty years of outstanding service with the Tennessee Wildlife Federation and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.